

## Asttects launches open source CRM suite

Months after delivering a community-backed communication solution, Asttects has launched its open source CRM application suite. The new development, called AstCRM, is designed to enable enterprises to manage all their customer engagement needs using the power of open source.

“Leveraging expertise in open source, our objective is to provide customers with best-of-breed enterprise-grade applications, while focusing mainly on the must-have features of a customer relationship management solution and major workflows,” said Manjunath R.J., CEO of AstCRM.

Asttects is targeting the CRM package at large enterprises and SMEs (small and medium enterprises). The solution can be used to improve prospect and customer experiences by automating sales, marketing and support tasks, while delivering business-enhancing insights.



To accomplish the customer relationship process, AstCRM includes major applications for tasks such as lead management, contact management, account management, ticket management, role management and activity management.

The suite allows users to access customer data via a Web browser. There are integrated plugins for Outlook, Thunderbird, Firefox and Gmail to let users configure the CRM using their email accounts.

Likewise, as open source software is dominating the cloud space, IBM aims to succeed in the market by partnering with its market leaders. Hybrid cloud application management company, Cloudsoft, is already using the combined service by deploying its Red Hat Enterprise Linux workloads in IBM's cloud solution. This use case is likely to be expanded over time.

“A cloud-first strategy has become the new normal for a majority of our enterprise clients worldwide who are leveraging IBM Cloud as a key driver for digital transformation,” Adam said.

## Microsoft's Project Olympus enlightens open source cloud path

About four months after its official launch, Project Olympus by Microsoft has finalised its future moves and expanded open source hardware development by



adding semiconductor manufacturers like NVIDIA, Intel, Qualcomm, AMD and Cavium. The new development is aimed at bringing full-fledged cloud hardware closer to the open source community.

Microsoft had announced Project Olympus in October last year to deliver a next-generation cloud hardware design, based on the company's massive belief in the success of open source. While the initial model is yet to be finalised, the Redmond company now plans to make open source cloud hardware a reality.

Microsoft is working closely with the Open Compute Project (OCP) team to enable its Project Olympus as an open source cooperative standard for server hardware that will provide both cloud and enterprise services. At the 2017 OCP US Summit, the software giant announced that Project Olympus had “attracted the latest in silicon innovation” — offering an advanced model for emerging cloud workloads such as Big Data analytics, machine learning and artificial intelligence.

To reach a large number of projects, Project Olympus standards will be seen in next generation Intel Xeon and AMD processors. The hardware standard will also support ARM processors by Qualcomm and Cavium. Interestingly, this will open up new verticals since ARM-based chips have till now never been associated with Microsoft software.

“This is a significant moment as we usher in a new era of open source hardware development with the OCP community. We intend Project Olympus to provide a blueprint for future hardware development and collaboration at cloud speed,” said Kushagra Vaid, general manager for Azure hardware infrastructure, Microsoft, in a statement.

Microsoft aims to build hardware that is robust, flexible as well as scalable in terms of capacity. The best part is, this standard is CPU independent. Moreover, the collaborative agreement between Project Olympus and the chipmakers will ensure this independence.

Apart from supporting advanced hardware, Microsoft is projecting a strong and quantifiable foundation for cloud software development with Project Olympus. Azure is expected to enable this software foundation through some of the recent open source projects.

The rapid rate of cloud adoption is already indicative of the fact that the future of computing is on the cloud. Therefore, a universal standard like Project Olympus is likely to help software makers be less dependent on hardware drivers and CPU specifications.

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